

In 1997, the United States Secretary of State Madeleine Albright spoke to the graduating class of Mount Holyoke College, a women's college in Massachusetts, USA. Within her speech to the graduating class of the college, she intends to inspire the students of their future endeavors past their education to serve as a reminder of the people they should strive to be and not know any bounds. Using repetition, contradictions, and epistrophe within her speech to the graduating class of the college, Albright intends to emphasize her message of the traits of modern feminism that she tries to convey.

Albright uses repetition largely to bring the audience back to the same position and divert them back to the main topic she meant to convey, in this case: determination that is needed in femininity. She repeats notable examples of her visits to other countries of which she was so inspired by which she utilizes their actions in her essay. She mentions how "in Sarajevo...women weighted down... [reach] out across ethnic lines to rebuild" and follows this immediately after by noting how she also met many other women in various different nations facing issues that are being bridged by women. She repeats this idea of focusing on women in various countries facing issues needing to be addressed to point out the determination of feminism that lies within them. Although they may not have the best resources nor the best equipment to fix large scale issues such as those mentioned by Albright about her various perspectives within her travels to companies, she notices that women have tried to fix these issues regardless. Thus, Albright uses these notable examples to emphasize the feminist determination shown that she intends her audience, of whom are all women, to be like: being adaptive to trouble and continuing.

To complement this push of feminist courage and perseverance, Albright uses historical examples and uses contradictions to emphasize the message within the speech. She initializes this by using an example such as how the "Berlin Wall is now a memory. [And] we could be satisfied by that" but contradicts this thought of comfort to that of work, courage, and perseverance when she uses the "enlarging and adapting NATO and striving to create a future for Europe...-including Russia". Albright uses these contradictory historical events to emphasize the change people should make and being proactive about their choices to make better decisions rather than ones that only benefit themselves. By emphasizing the overarching hand of help and security that are characterized by historical allusions, Albright attempts to convey a similar emotion within her all-female crowd of the value and importance of not being selfish and to be proactive in the aid of others which can instill the feelings of safety within a larger context, not just themselves.

To prove her point once and for all, Albright continues to utilize epistrophe in order to emphasize the importance of courage and perseverance within feminist culture to her crowd. Following a statement of determination, she proceeds to mention the importance of courage and perseverance she wants the women to instill. She states in multiple ways at the end of each paragraph "But no matter how [insert challenge], have courage still - and persevere." By the utilization of this tactic, she attempts to bring the crowd back to her main point every single time of how she wants them to have courage and perseverance regardless of the situation presented at the time. Thus, by this epistrophe, she effectively conveys that the women she addressed

should be the people who bring change and are the doers regardless of the challenges they face.

Within her speech to the graduating class of 1997 at Holyoke College, Albright attempts to convey the values that make a good person, and most of all a better woman by pushing the modern feminist values signaling a change from the dormancy they had, to the change they should bring now.